

Customer Personas & Buyer Journey

Understand your customers.
Create better experiences. Grow your business.



Know
Your Customers



Create
Relevant Content



Map
Their Journey



Drive
Better Results

Different
People.
Different Needs.

The right message.
To the right people.
At the right time.

From
Understanding
to Growth



Awareness
Discover



Consideration
Explore



Purchase
Buy



Loyalty
Return & Recommend

Is “Students” Enough?

Imagine you are launching a food-delivery service for college students. You say: “Our target customer is students.”

No.

Two students can be the same age, attend the same college, and live in the same city — but want completely different things.

Same Students.
Different Cravings.



Student A

“Budget First”

Age	20 years
College	Same college
Lives in	Same city
Goal	Cheapest possible food
Preference	Budget meals, offers, combos
Decision factor	Price



Student B

“Healthy & Fast”

Age	20 years
College	Same college
Lives in	Same city
Goal	Healthy food delivered quickly
Preference	Nutritious meals, minimal oil, fast delivery
Decision factor	Health + speed

So, We Need to Go Deeper



What does the customer **want**?



What **problem** are they trying to solve?



What **influences** their decision?



Key Takeaway

A customer segment can have very different needs. **Go beyond basic demographics.**

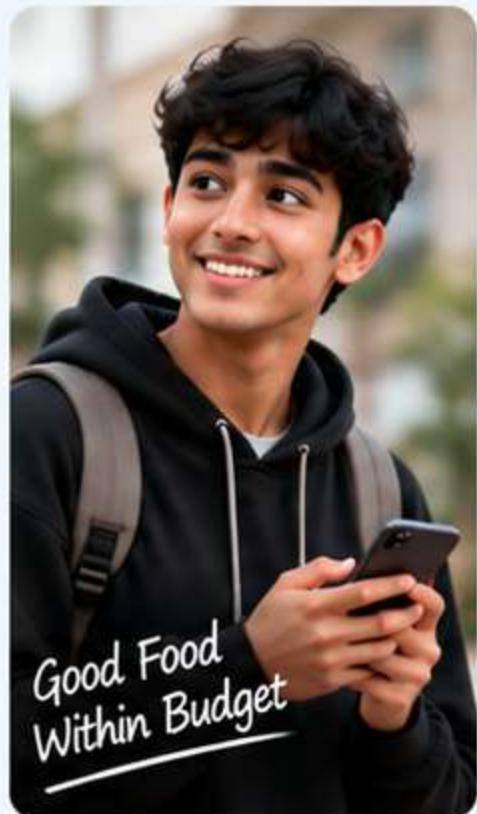
Understand deeper.
Serve better.

What Is a Customer Persona?

A customer persona is a realistic profile representing an important customer group.

*Same
Students.
Different
Needs.*

Persona 1 — Budget Student



	Age	20
	Occupation	College student
	Budget	Low
	Goal	Affordable meals
	Pain point	Delivery charges are expensive
	Preference	Discounts and combo meals

Persona 2 — Busy Student



	Age	21
	Occupation	College student
	Budget	Medium
	Goal	Save time
	Pain point	Long waiting times
	Preference	Fast delivery



Notice the Difference

- ✓ Both are students.
- ✓ Same age group.
- ✓ But their **needs** are different.

Understanding these differences helps us create better products, marketing messages and experiences.



Key Takeaway

A customer persona helps us understand different customer groups and their **specific needs**.

*Different People.
Better Solutions.*

What Goes Into a Persona?

Keep it simple. A customer persona includes the key information that helps us understand the customer.



The Important Question Is:

“Why would this person **choose our product?**”



Demographics

Who are they?

- Age
- Location
- Occupation
- Income / budget

Basic details about the customer.



Goals

What do they want?

“I want affordable food.”

Their needs, aspirations and what they want to achieve.



Pain Points

What problems do they face?

“Delivery charges are too high.”

Challenges, frustrations or barriers.



Preferences

What influences their decision?

“I usually choose offers.”

Price, quality, convenience, reviews, brand, offers, etc.



Key Takeaway

A good persona helps us understand the customer and make **better business decisions**.

Understand People.
Build Better Solutions.

Customer Segmentation

You don't always have one type of customer. Divide your customers into meaningful groups.

Same
Coffee.
Different
People.



Students

"Affordable drinks"



Budget-friendly options



College nearby



Hang out with friends



Offers and discounts



Office Workers

"Quick service"



Fast service



Near office location



Good coffee to stay productive



Prefer weekday visits



Freelancers

"Wi-Fi and comfortable seating"



Reliable Wi-Fi



Comfortable seating



Quiet environment



Stay for longer hours



Premium Customers

"Specialty coffee"



High-quality, unique flavors



Premium experience



Willing to pay more



Value brand and ambiance



Key Takeaway

Different customer groups have different needs. Understanding them helps you create better products, services and marketing strategies.

Know Your Customers.
Serve Them Better.

Don't Let AI Invent Your Customer

AI can be helpful, but a persona should be based on real customer data — not assumptions.

You Ask AI

“Create a persona for a 20-year-old Indian college student.”



AI Might Say

“They love Instagram, prefer trendy brands, order food at night, and are price sensitive.”

Looks useful, right?

But ask yourself...

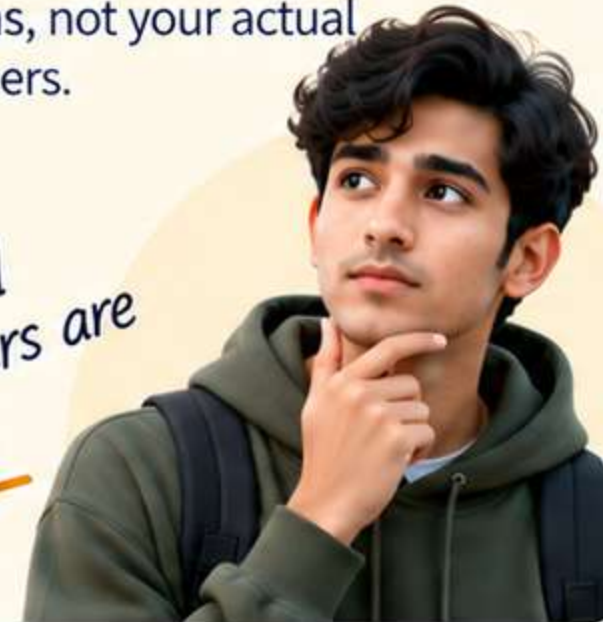


Where did that information come from?

AI May Be Making Assumptions

This information might sound real, but AI may simply be generating it based on general patterns, not your actual customers.

Not all answers are facts.



A Persona Should Be Supported By:

-  Customer surveys
-  Interviews
-  Purchase history
-  Website/app analytics
-  Reviews
-  Social media behavior
-  Customer feedback
-  Demographic data
-  Search behavior



Key Takeaway

AI can **organize** customer data. It should not **replace** customer research.

*Real Customers.
Real Data.
Better Decisions.*

Prompt: Create an Evidence-Based Persona

Use this prompt to generate a customer persona based only on your actual customer data.

Prompt to Use

Create a customer persona using only the customer data provided below.

Include:

- Name
- Age range
- Occupation
- Goals
- Pain points
- Preferences
- Buying behavior

Clearly separate:

1. Facts directly supported by the data
2. Reasonable hypotheses

Do not invent customer characteristics.

Customer data:
[Paste your data]

From data
to useful
insights

Example Output (Illustrative)



Rahul

Age range: 19–22

Occupation: College student

"I want good food at a reasonable price."



Goals

- Affordable meals
- Try new food options



Pain points

- High delivery charges
- Limited budget



Preferences

- Discounts and combo meals
- Popular and trendy food items



Buying behavior

- Orders 2–4 times per week
- Often orders at night



Facts (from data)

- Age range: 19–22 (from survey data)
- Occupation: College student (from survey data)
- Orders 2–4 times per week (from app analytics)
- Often orders at night (from order history)
- Price is an important factor (from survey responses)



Reasonable Hypotheses

- Likely looks for trendy food options (based on popular items among this age group)
- May be influenced by social media (common behavior in this segment)
- Interested in trying new cuisines (based on variety in past orders)



This is much safer than:
"Create my ideal customer."



Key Takeaway

Use **real customer data**. Let AI organize and analyze it — **not invent** your customer.

*Better Prompts.
Better Insights.
Better Business.*

What Is a Buyer Journey?

A buyer journey shows the steps a customer goes through before, during and after making a purchase.

*Not just
a purchase,
but a journey.*

1 Awareness

"I need a new laptop."



Realizes a need or identifies a problem.

2 Consideration

"Which laptop should I buy?"



Looks for options, reads reviews, asks for suggestions.

3 Evaluation

"HP or Lenovo? Which has better specifications?"



Compares features, prices, and reviews to make a decision.

4 Purchase

"I'll buy this one."



Makes the purchase and completes the transaction.

5 Post-purchase

"Was this a good decision?"



Uses the product, shares feedback, and may become a loyal customer.



Key Takeaway

Customers go through multiple steps before making a purchase. Understanding the buyer journey helps us create **better products, marketing messages and customer experiences.**

*Meet Customers
Where They Are.*

Touchpoints

A touchpoint is any interaction between the customer and the business.



Every interaction can influence the customer's decision.

1 Awareness

Instagram advertisement



Customer first learns about the product.

2 Consideration

Website



Customer explores options and learns more.

3 Evaluation

YouTube review



Customer compares features, prices and reads/watches reviews.

4 Purchase

E-commerce checkout



Customer makes the purchase.

5 Post-purchase

Email / WhatsApp support



Customer gets support and builds a relationship with the brand.



Key Takeaway

Touchpoints across the buyer journey shape the customer's **experience** and influence their **decision**.

*Small Interactions
Create Big Impact.*

Simple Buyer Journey Example

Imagine a student buying from a coffee shop.

From
First Sip
to a Fan

1 Awareness



Sees an Instagram Reel.

2 Consideration



Checks the menu.

3 Purchase



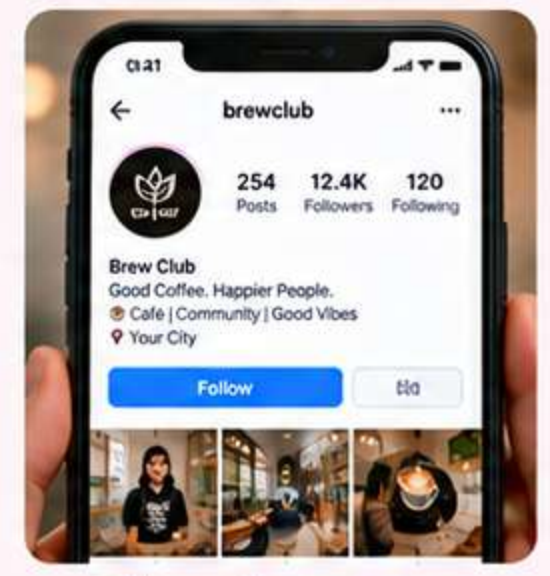
Visits the café.

4 Experience



Tries the coffee.

5 Loyalty



Follows the Instagram page and returns next week.

? **Where can the business improve the experience?**



Maybe the menu is confusing.



Maybe ordering takes too long.



Maybe there is no loyalty offer.



Key Takeaway

Mapping the buyer journey helps **identify opportunities** to improve the customer experience.

Better Journeys
Create Loyal Customers.

AI Prompt for Buyer Journey

Use this prompt to create a buyer journey map for a customer persona.



Use real customer data where possible.
Clearly mark assumptions.



Prompt to Use

Create a buyer journey map for this customer persona.

Stages:

1. Awareness
2. Consideration
3. Purchase
4. Post-purchase
5. Loyalty

For each stage identify:

- Customer goal
- Customer action
- Possible pain point
- Business touchpoint
- Opportunity for improvement

Use only the information provided.
Clearly mark assumptions.

Customer persona:

[Paste persona]



Example Output (for a student coffee shop persona)

	 1. Awareness	 2. Consideration	 3. Purchase	 4. Post-purchase	 5. Loyalty
 Customer goal	Discover a good coffee shop nearby.	Check menu and options.	Buy and try the coffee.	Feel satisfied with the experience.	Return and stay connected.
 Customer action	Sees an Instagram Reel.	Visits the website or Instagram page to view the menu.	Visits the café and places an order.	Enjoys the coffee and leaves feedback (maybe).	Follows the Instagram page and visits again next week.
 Possible pain point	Might not notice the ad.	Menu may be confusing.	Long waiting time.	No easy way to give feedback.	No loyalty offers or reminders.
 Business touchpoint	Instagram advertisement.	Website / Instagram menu.	In-store experience (ordering and payment).	In-store experience and receipt.	Instagram page, email/WhatsApp (optional).
 Opportunity for improvement	Create engaging and relevant content for students.	Simplify menu and highlight popular items.	Speed up ordering process (e.g., pre-order or self-service).	Ask for feedback (e.g., QR code) and respond to reviews.	Introduce loyalty rewards and send updates on new offers.



Note

This is an example output. Use your own customer data and clearly mark any assumptions.



Key Takeaway

A buyer journey map helps you understand what customers **experience** and where you can **improve**.

Better Insights.
Happier Customers.

Activity — Your Turn

Apply what you have learned and create your own personas and buyer journey.



Goal

Understand your customers better and identify opportunities to improve their experience.

1 Choose a Business

Select one of the following (or your own idea):



Coffee shop



Clothing brand



Food delivery app



Gym



Online learning platform



Smartphone brand

2 Create 2 Customer Personas

For each persona, identify:



Who are they?

(Age, occupation, location, etc.)



What do they want?

(Goals)



What problem do they have?

(Pain points)



What influences their purchase?

(Preferences, factors, etc.)

3 Map the Buyer Journey

Create a buyer journey for each persona with these stages:



Awareness



Consideration



Purchase



Post-purchase



Loyalty

4 Identify Touchpoints

List 3 important touchpoints for your business.

1

2

3



Discussion

- What opportunities did you find to improve the customer experience?
- How can these insights help the business grow?



Tip

Be realistic. Use examples you are familiar with.
You can do quick research to make your personas more accurate.